

changes in the `rc` file or directly from the Settings view as in the case of keybindings.

Shortcomings

As already said, being a console application, this player lacks obvious features such as cover flow, visualisations and other fancy plug-ins. Two major issues for me are that there is no option to fetch the lyrics of the currently playing song and no simple way to submit the tracks to the audio scrobbling service such as last.fm or librefm. The addition of these two features would make CMus the first choice for me. Anyway, these features have been requested and the developers have said that they will be added in the next release.

Last.fm support

Since I feel it's a must to show off my music status to everyone who cares, I scrobble the tracks I listen to in last.fm. Obviously, it was one of the first things I tried to achieve by whatever means possible. As I said, there is no 'easy' way to integrate the last.fm scrobble support. There is, however, a hard way to achieve this. Don't worry; you don't have to write code. You only need to compile the latest git version from the source. Developer Frank Terbek wrote a patch to achieve this. Get the current copy of the git repository from:

```
git clone git://repo.or.cz/cmusc.git
```

Once you have that, download the patch from http://www.hci-matters.com/blog/wp-content/uploads/2008/05/06/cmusc_audioscrobberBETA41-githead.diff. Now place this in the source directory of CMus and patch it:

```
patch < cmusc_audioscrobberBETA41-githead.diff
```

Once this is done, use the usual procedure to install a software from source (`./configure && make && make-install`). Then, open the CMus `rc` file (if you don't have one, make it under `~/cmusc/rc`) and add the following lines to it:

```
set as_enable=true
set as_user=(Your Last.fm Username)
```

```
set as_pass=(Your Last.fm Password)
```

Insert your user name and password at the appropriate places and you are done! Now the CMus player will scrobble the tracks you listen to at your last.fm account. To turn the scrobbling off, just change the first option value to false.

Remote controlling

If you are running CMus on a different workspace, or just want to change the song from an IRC client, you can use a program called `cmus-remote` to change the state of the player. Apart from the usual features of play, pause, next and previous, you can also load new playlists or empty the queue. It's a very handy tool to create scripts for standalone console (or other) applications. Type `cmus-remote --help` to get the commands that the application supports.

Finally...

The major advantage of CMus is the speed. It's very lightweight and I have been running it on my old system with a 500 MHz Celeron processor and 96 MB of RAM on Debian without a single glitch. The maximum RAM used was less than ~20MB at all times. With the likes of Amarok and Exaile taking more than 50 MB of RAM, CMus is a great alternative for your low-end systems. Sure, it's not at all as good looking as the other two, but certainly as powerful... if not more so.

On the down side, with no support for lyrics fetching and artist information retrieval available for CMus, many people will be reluctant to use it. The last.fm support, though technically there, still lacks the ease and usability that the other players support. With most of the users requesting these features, the developers have agreed to include the patches in the next major release, so it looks like CMus has a very bright future ahead of it. My call? You must try it at least once to know its power. **END** 

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